

ICU SPRING LECTURES ON LINGUISTICS

Wednesdays, 5:30pm – 7:00pm, 4/22, 4/29, 5/13, 5/20, 5/27
Room: H(onkan) 301

These lectures are part of an advanced undergraduate linguistics course that S. Miyagawa is teaching. The lectures are in Japanese except Miyagawa's on 4/22.

The easiest way to get to ICU is to take the Kokusai Kirisutokyo Daigaku bus from Musashisakai. It will bring you onto campus. Honkan is a few minutes walk from the bus stop. There is also a Kokusai Kirisutokyo Daigaku bus from Mitaka.

April 22, 5:30-7:00, H-301

Integration hypothesis and the rapid emergence of language in evolution (see below for abstracts)

Shigeru Miyagawa, MIT/UTokyo/ICU (Will be in English)

April 29, 5:30-7:00, H-301

Acquisition of “only”: Understanding Crain's puzzle

Ayaka Sugawara, Mie University

(Joint project with Martin Hackl and Ken Wexler)

May 13, 5:30-7:00, H-301

Split movement of wh-elements in Japanese Sign Language: A Preliminary Study

Asako Uchibori and Kazumi Matsuoka

Nihon University Keio University

May 20, 5:30-7:00, H-301

To introspect or not?: Invitation to experimental syntax

Shigeto Kawahara, Keio University

May 27, 5:30-7:00, H-301

Nominative/Genitive Conversion

Masao Ochi, Osaka University

ABSTRACTS

April 22, 5:30-7:00, H-301

Integration hypothesis and the rapid emergence of language in evolution

Shigeru Miyagawa, MIT/UTokyo/ICU

The Integration Hypothesis (Miyagawa et al. 2013, 2014 *Frontiers*) starts with the observation that there are essentially two primary systems in the animal kingdom that underlie communication: L-type, for lexical, like the alarm calls, consisting of isolated verbal or gestural signals that have reference in the real world; and E-type, for expressive,

like birdsong, that creates patterns, but the patterns themselves do not have unique meaning. The idea is that the L- and E-types integrated uniquely in humans to give rise to language. I will briefly review recent genetic and cellular research results that are compatible with the Integration Hypothesis (Pfenning 2014, Calabreze and Woolley 2015, Harris 2015). Taking these works as a starting point, I will argue that the Integration Hypothesis provides an articulated framework for viewing language as having emerged rapidly in evolution without the need for a protolanguage stage (Nóbrega and Miyagawa 2015).

April 29, 5:30-7:00, H-301

Acquisition of “only”: Understanding Crain’s puzzle

Ayaka Sugawara, Mie University

(Joint project with Martin Hackl and Ken Wexler)

There is a long-standing puzzle in acquisition of “only” since Crain et al. (1994): children up to age 6 display difficulties understanding sentences with pre-subject “only” (“subject-only”, as in “Only the cat is holding a flag.”) while having no difficulty understanding sentences with pre-VP “only” (“VP-only”, as in “The cat is only holding a flag.”). Interestingly the asymmetry in children’s comprehension is found cross-linguistically (e.g. Endo 2004 for Japanese, Notley et al. 2009 for Mandarin, Müller et al. 2011 for German). In this talk, I will present results from experimental projects with Martin Hackl and Ken Wexler and argue that what is difficult for children is not about interpreting Subject-only sentences, but about learning how to accommodate an appropriate implicit question when the pair of a question and an answer is not congruent. Specifically, we note that neither “subject-only” nor “VP-only” are congruent with a broad question (e.g. “What happened?”), which is typically used to prompt puppet’s answers in experiments in the literature. Instead, the sentences with “only” are congruent with different sub-questions, which we hypothesize that listeners must accommodate during comprehension. Our experiments compare children’s adult-like responses when we use broad questions and children’s responses when we use sub-questions. The results show that children are sensitive to Question-Answer Congruence (QAC) and support the idea that accommodation of sub-questions of “What happened?” plays a role in the asymmetry.

May 13, 5:30-7:00, H-301

Split movement of wh-elements in Japanese Sign Language: A Preliminary Study

Asako Uchibori and Kazumi Matsuoka

Nihon University Keio University

In Japanese Sign Language (JSL), as well as in many other sign languages, wh-final sentences are common, which is not the case of spoken languages. This paper is an attempt to explain how wh-final constructions in JSL are derived under the generative approach. We will observe the basic distributions of the wh-element in wh-final constructions including the wh-double (i.e., wh-initial and wh-final) construction, and argue that previous approaches to wh-finals in other sign languages, such as Cecchetto et al. (2011) and Petronio and Lillo-Martin (1997), cannot be directly applied to JSL wh-

finals. We propose that the wh-sign with the non-manual marker for the wh-interrogative (wh-NMM), is split into two segments; the wh-NMM as a wh-interrogative marker and the wh-sign as a wh-operator. Under this proposal, splitting of the wh-element and movement of each segment take place in the wh-double construction. That is, while the clause-final wh-sign occupies the head position with the [+Q] feature realized as the wh-NMM, the wh-sign accompanied by the wh-NMM can be moved from its original position to the clause-initial position by wh-operator movement. In either case, the wh-NMM must co-occur with the wh-sign, since the wh-NMM needs to be morphologically supported.

May 20, 5:30-7:00, H-301

To introspect or not?: Invitation to experimental syntax

Shigeto Kawahara, Keio University

Generative studies often build their theories based on intuitive grammatical judgments. It is not even uncommon that these intuition-based data come from authors themselves. Since the inception of Generative Grammar, there have been constant criticisms against this methodology, mainly from psychologists and other cognitive scientists. In this talk I would like to reexamine this issue from a modern perspective. In particular, I discuss what I think is the most constructive way to respond to the anti-generative criticisms; namely, showing by way of experiments that the intuition-based data are not necessarily unreliable. The talk heavily relies on the series of recent work by Jon Sprouse and his colleagues, augmented by my own experimental work.

May 27, 5:30-7:00, H-301

Nominative/Genitive Conversion

Masao Ochi, Osaka University

Nominative/Genitive Conversion, also known as Ga/No Conversion (GNC), has received a great deal of attention in the generative literature, starting with Harada's (1971) seminal work on this topic. In this presentation, I will first review three main proposals that have figured prominently in the past literature: D-licensing (Miyagawa 1993, 2011 and Ochi 2001 among many others), C-licensing (Watanabe 1996 and Hiraiwa 2001, 2005), and weak *v* licensing (in conjunction with dependent tense) (Miyagawa 2012). I will place them under careful scrutiny by highlighting their theoretical merits and potential drawbacks. Then I will discuss some GNC paradigms from some Kyushu dialects where GNC occurs quite extensively, much more so than in standard Japanese (where the domain of GNC is confined to adnominal clauses and a subset of temporal adjunct clauses). I will attempt to draw some theoretical conclusions about the nature of GNC in light of the commonalities that are observed between the GNC in such Kyushu dialects and the GNC in standard Japanese.